



SEMAPHORE TRAFFIC SYSTEM

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DIRECTION

Owner: Orientation | **Related:** Canon, Judgment, EIB, provenance, temporal integrity | **Cross-reference:**
PROVENANCE_AND_LINEAGE.md; TEMPORAL_INTEGRITY.md; AI_AUTHORITY_AND_HUMAN_AUTHORSHIP.md

Revision authority: The [September 6 canon closeout addendum](#) locks the precedence vocabulary and supersedes the earlier PROVISIONAL/deferred vocabulary state. The broader runtime implementation remains open; earlier approvals retain their historical scope.

Semaphore is the cable-like longitudinal intelligence/decision traffic medium: durable, searchable, threaded, referential, supersession-aware, historically navigable, and human-authored. It is not Slack with formal typography and not a one-page cap on major decisions.

Traffic retains durable ID, human originator, issue/event time, subject stating why it matters, concise point-first opening, references/thread, distribution/access, business line/topics, related decisions/problems, corrections/supersession, and handling precedence where useful. Routine / Priority / Immediate / Flash are the LOCKED precedence labels. Orientation Officers exercise professional judgment over what merits traffic; policy does not enumerate every allowed subject.

The record captures decisions, relied-upon judgments, alternatives, assumptions, unknowns, dissent, evidence references, predictions, triggers, later changes, and supersession—not every hallway conversation, private thought, or interpersonal influence chain. Retention follows future legal/privacy rules while preserving provenance wherever lawful.

AI may assist research; only a human Orientation Officer writes/issues institutional traffic. Daedalus cannot author, issue, or promote a cable.

Institutional purpose

Semaphore carries the institution's evolving understanding across time and organizational distance. It is not chat, email, a ticket queue, a document repository, or a one-page decision memo. A cable can report a change, anomaly, field condition, consequential interpretation, correction, dissent, decision context, or other matter that an Orientation Officer judges worthy of durable institutional traffic. The medium remains broad because professional judgment—not an eligibility checklist—determines what deserves a cable.

Cable construction

The subject tells a reader why the traffic matters rather than merely naming a project. The opening states the point concisely. The body preserves enough context, evidence references, assumptions, confidence, alternatives, unknowns, and dissent for a future reader to understand the issue without pretending one cable is the entire record.

A durable cable ID never changes. Origin identifies the human issuing office/officer. Event, issue, and record times remain distinguishable. Distribution reflects information nature and need, not prestige. References create explicit threads across earlier/later cables, Judgment Problems, decisions, Canon states, EIB items, JAG deployments, finance assumptions, and source material.

Handling precedence

The four precedence levels express handling urgency only:

Level	Meaning
Routine	Handle through the normal reading and response cycle.
Priority	Expedite; waiting for the normal cycle could materially impair a decision.
Immediate	Interrupt normal work for prompt attention; an active situation needs a timely response.
Flash	Exceptional, time-critical traffic where delay could cause severe, imminent consequences.

Precedence does not establish truth, confidence, author seniority, permanent importance, or authority to command. A Routine cable may be strategically profound; a Flash cable may contain uncertain information. Precedence does not change distribution, access restrictions, human authorship, or the authority of the underlying record.

Foundational doctrine sets no fixed response-time targets or service-level promises. Operational procedures may define justified response targets without changing the meaning of these labels.

Cable metadata and search/catalog representations use this accepted vocabulary wherever precedence is represented. Historical records retain the vocabulary and state actually recorded at the time; the new decision does not silently backfill missing precedence or rewrite earlier traffic. Contact's separate Flash / Current / Active / Standing collection-tempo vocabulary is not resolved by this decision.

Threading, correction, and supersession

A reply or follow-on references the earlier cable while remaining its own record. A correction states what was wrong, what changes, why, and which downstream readers or artifacts may be affected. Supersession identifies the new controlling traffic without making the prior cable disappear. A cable may remain historically significant even when its conclusion is wrong.

Thread navigation supports chronological reading, branch/alternative interpretation, forward reliance, backward sourcing, and related-topic traversal. Traffic concerning transportation scheduling, for example, remains discoverable across years even when authors used different project names.

Authorship and accountability

The Orientation Officer exercises judgment about issue, framing, distribution, and record state and is accountable for the issued traffic. AI can retrieve, compare, challenge, and support research, but an officer must independently understand and author the cable. There is no “approve generated draft” process that makes Daedalus the hidden institutional author.

Semaphore records the institutional mind—not a forensic influence map. It preserves relied-upon judgments, assumptions, dissent, alternatives, predictions, and change. It does not attempt to capture every conversation or assign later blame for private interpersonal influence.